

Big impact: A solitary goal by Sergio Gonzalez (extreme right) was enough for Leganes to script an unexpected win against topper Barcelona. REUTERS

coming back twice after being a goal down, with Cody Gakpo and Diogo Jota finding the net.

Mikel Arteta's Arsenal failed to collect all three points after playing out a goalless draw against Everton. On the other hand, Chelsea stayed in the title race with a 2-1 win against Brentford, but it was not a perfect outing for the Blues as Marc Cucurella saw a red card in the eighth minute of second-half stoppage time.

Tottenham Hotspur blew away Southampton with a 5-0 win in a dominant display of football, and Nottingham Forest continued to impress with a 2-1 comeback win against Aston Villa.

After matchday 16, Liverpool tops the standings with 36 points. Chelsea, Arsenal and Nottingham Forest occupy second, third and fourth with 34, 30 and 28 points, respectively, with all having played a game more than Liverpool. Man City stays fifth with 27 points and Man United are 13th with 22 points.

La Liga

It was a frustrating week for the big two of Spanish top-flight football.

Real Madrid, chasing Barcelona in the title race, lost some momentum after playing out a 3-3 draw against Rayo Vallecano. Unai López and Abdul Mumin put Vallecano 2-0 up, but Los Blancos returned strongly courtesy of a long-distance screamer from Federico Valverde (**right**) and a strike from Jude Bellingham. Ancelotti's men took the lead in the 56th minute through Rodrygo but could not hold on to it, with Isi Palazón scoring the equaliser for Vallecano in the 64th minute.



AP



Barcelona had the perfect chance to capitalise on Madrid dropping points, and facing a lowly Leganés side, the equation seemed simple enough for Hansi Flick's men. But in one of the upsets of the season, Leganés edged a 1-0 win with Sergio González finding the net in the fourth minute.

Barca dominated the proceedings with 20 shots (four on target) and 81 per cent of the ball. Flick's men had an xG (expected goals) of 2.90 compared to Leganés' 0.3, but keeper Marko Dmitrović made multiple saves to maintain his team's slender lead.

It was not the most dominant